



GLOBAL GOVERNANCE & SUMMITS (2026 FOCUS)



BRICS EXPANSION & 2026 AGENDA



'Following 2024 expansion, now focus on internal integration.'



BRICS Centre for Industrial Competencies (BCIC)
Promoting industrial cooperation and tech transfer.



Local Currencies Usage
Agenda prioritizes bypassing US dollar.



Alternative Payment Systems
Developing a non-SWIFT payment network for member security.



UN SECURITY COUNCIL (UNSC) REFORMS



- **Intense 2026 Discussions:** On expanding permanent & non-permanent seats.



India's Role:

Advocating for a permanent seat to reflect 'contemporary geopolitical realities'.
Key argument: '**Upholding global representation.**'



G7 & GLOBAL SECURITY



- **Russia-Ukraine Conflict**
Continued focus, long-term security commitments, reconstruction support.



- **Maritime Security (Indo-Pacific)**
Securing vital sea lanes, promoting "Freedom of Navigation."



- **Critical Minerals Supply Chains:**
Strengthening chains, reducing dependence on singular sources (e.g., for green energy).



INDIA-UN DEVELOPMENT PARTNERSHIP FUND



- **Focus:** Continued commitment to South-South cooperation.
- **Priorities:** Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs).



In developing countries.

ABHISHA AI by Abhishek Pathak





AI: NEW DELHI DECLARATION, INDIAAI MISSION 2.0 & AI IMPACT SUMMIT (2026)

ABHISHA
AI
by Abhishek Pathak

'Emerging Technologies and Artificial Intelligence (AI) for UPSC Prelims 2026'

1

NEW DELHI DECLARATION ON AI IMPACT 2026

≡ Total 89+ Signatories ≡

1: DEMOCRATIZING
AI RESOURCES
(Compute, Data Access)

7: RESILIENCE &
EFFICIENCY
(Energy-efficient AI
Infrastructure)

5: ACCESS FOR SOCIAL
EMPOWERMENT
(Bridge Digital Divide)

Influenced by Indian principles like **Vasudhaiva
Vasudhaiva Kutumbakam* (One World Family)

Key aim: Ethical, Democratic, and Collaborative AI

7 "CHAKRAS"
(Pillars)

2: ECONOMIC GROWTH
& SOCIAL GOOD
(Healthcare, Agri, Edu)

3: Safety, Transparency
Standards)

4: AI FOR SCIENCE
(Global Research Collab)

6: HUMAN CAPITAL
(Energy-efficient AI

INDIAAI MISSION 2.0

Core focus on **SOVEREIGN AI**

"UPI OF AI" MODEL

Plug-and-Play AI Tools
for MSMEs & Rural sectors. MSME

MASSIVE COMPUTE EXPANSION

- Targeting 38,000+ GPUs
- Public-Private Partnerships
(e.g., Tata-OpenAI HyperVault 100MW)

BHARATGEN

Indigenous Large Multimodal
Models (LMMs) for 22 Indian
languages

SEMICONDUCTOR SECURITY
Securing Hardware Supply
Chain

3

AI IMPACT SUMMIT 2026

At Bharat Mandapam, New Delhi

Focus: Workforce, Sustainability, Regulation

WORKFORCE DISRUPTION

- Equitable AI Transition Playbook
- e-Shram AI Integration for
informal workers (Micro-credentials)

TRUSTED AI COMMONS

- Global repository for safe, accurate AI,
preventing misinformation/hallucinations

GLOBAL IMPACT CHALLENGES

- AI FOR ALL (Public Services)
- AI BY HER (Women Leadership)
- YUVAi (Youth Innovation)

CURRENT AFFAIRS - ENVIRONMENT: Key Global & National Initiatives

1. 20 CITIES TOWARDS ZERO WASTE INITIATIVE



- ➔ **Lead Entities:** UN Secretary-General's Advisory Board on Zero Waste + UNEP support.
- ➔ **Main Objective:** Transition urban centers to circular economies (SDG 12).
- ➔ **Indian Connection:** Varkala (Kerala) - named in initiative.
- ➔ **Focus:** Waste segregation, reducing landfills, Zero Waste philosophy.



3. GLOBAL HEAT HEALTH INFORMATION NETWORK (GHHIN)



- ➔ **Key Partners:** World Health Organization (WHO) + World Meteorological Organization (WMO).
- ➔ **Focus:** Climate change adaptation & heat health surveillance.
- ➔ **Action:** Strengthen Heat-Health Warning Systems (HHWS).
- ➔ **Indian Context:** Ahmedabad Heat Action Plan (HAP) as a global model.



2. GLOBAL INITIATIVE ON THE TAKING OF MIGRATORY SPECIES (GTI)



- ➔ **Legal Framework:** Operates under the Bonn Convention (CMS - Convention on Migratory Species).
- ➔ **Main Goal:** Curb illegal killing, taking, & trade (IKTT) of CMS-listed species.
- ➔ **India & CMS:** India is a party; hosted CMS COP13 (Gandhinagar).
- ➔ **Impact:** Tackles threats across international borders.



4. UNESCO RIVER LINK ADVISORY: AGHANASHINI-VEDAVATHI



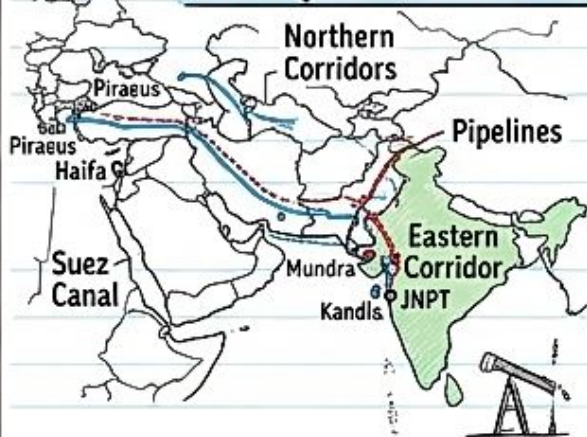
- ➔ **The Project:** Linking Aghanashini River to Vedavathi River (Karnataka).
- ➔ **Conservation Concerns:** Aghanashini estuary is a Ramsar Site; catchment in Western Ghats.
- ➔ **UNESCO Stand:** Compliance with World Heritage norms required.
- ➔ **Goal:** Ensure 'Outstanding Universal Value' (OUV) of Western Ghats is not compromised.



UPSC CSE PRELIMS 2026: KEY STRATEGIC DEVELOPMENTS

CRITICAL ISSUES IN TRADE, MARITIME, & SECURITY

IMEC (India-Middle East-Europe Economic Corridor)



- **TWO-CORRIDOR STRUCTURE:** Eastern & Northern
- **STRATEGIC RATIONALE:** Strategic alternative to Suez Canal, avoid Red Sea chokepoints, 'de-risking'
- **COMPONENTS:** High-speed Rail, Hydrogen Pipelines, Digital Cables
- **ANTICIPATED GAINS:**
 - 40% Transit Time
 - 30% Logistics Costs

PRELIMS 'TRAP' POINTS TO WATCH



WTO 14th MINISTERIAL CONFERENCE (MC14) - Yaoundé, Cameroon

KEY ISSUE: IFD Agreement (Investment Facilitation for Development)

NATURE: Plurilateral agreement (120+ members)

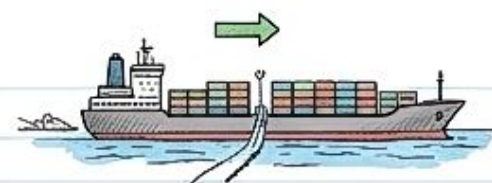
INDIA'S STANCE: Formally Blocked Inclusion in WTO Framework

INDIA'S CAUTION/ARGUMENTS:

1. **MANDATE:** Investment is not 'Trade', falls outside WTO scope.
2. **SOVEREIGNTY:** Limits national 'policy space' for regulation. India's strategic opposition to IFD at WTO MC14
3. **NON-CONSENSUS:** Plurilateral cannot be forced multilaterally without full consensus

WATCH:

India's strategic opposition to IFD at WTO MC14



PARTNERSHIP FOR INDO-PACIFIC INDUSTRIAL RESILIENCE (PIPIR)



FOCUS: Defense-Industrial Base Strengthening

PARTICIPANTS: 14 Indo-Pacific Nations (inc. INDIA, USA, Japan, Aus)

GOAL: Reduce single-source supply chain reliance (e.g., from China)

KEY AREAS: MRO Facilities (Maintenance, Repair, Overhaul), localized repairs of US-origin gear (e.g., P-8I aircraft)

SECURITY LINK: Enhances Maritime Domain Awareness (MDA)

PRELIMS 'TRAP' POINTS TO WATCH:
IMEC: NOT World Bank/IMF; Treaty-based involving India, UAE, Saudi, EU, USA

IFD:
PLURILATERAL, not Multilateral; India blocked it based on principle of consensus

PIPIR:
Specifically about DEFENSE-INDUSTRIAL Supply Chains, not just general trade

INDIA'S GAME AT THE WTO

OPERATION THUNDER 2025/2026



NATURE: Global Law Enforcement Operation

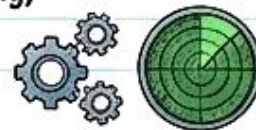
COORDINATORS: INTERPOL & World Customs Organization (WCO)

TARGET: Illegal Wildlife & Timber Trade (Environmental Crime)

SIGNIFICANCE FOR INDIA: Crackdown on Red Sanders, Pangolin scales trafficking

GLOBAL IMPACT: Over 4,600 seizures (2025 cycle), 134 countries

TREND: Crime Convergence (Environmental crime linked to money laundering)



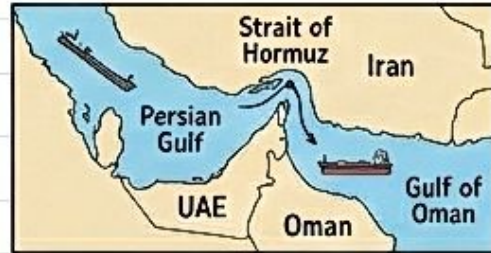
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PLACES & SPECIES IN NEWS (UPSC PRELIMS 2026)

1. STRAIT OF HORMUZ

CONTEXT: High volatility due to West Asia Tensions (Iran-Israel-US conflict)

IMPACT: Affects Global Oil Supply Lines



→ **INDIA'S STAKE:** Strategic energy security, oil imports

KEY DATA:
Chokepoint for ~20% of Global Oil consumption (20M bpd)



3. EMPEROR PENGUIN

STATUS CHANGE: Declared ENDANGERED by IUCN (2026)

DESIGNATION: Endangered SENTINEL SPECIES

DRIVER: Climate Change (Sea ice loss affecting breeding & chick survival)



2. LIPULEKH PASS

CONTEXT: Reopening for India-China Border Trade

SCHEDULE: Scheduled for June 2026



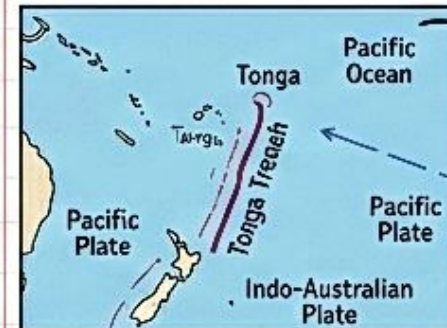
SIGNIFICANCE: Key route for Kailash Mansarovar Yatra; cross-border trade link with TAR (Tibet)

NOTE: Part of Kalapani territory dispute (India-Nepal)



4. TONGA (South Pacific)

RECENT EVENT: Experienced 7.6 Magnitude Earthquake



VULNERABILITY: Region hyper-sensitive after Hunga Tonga eruption (2022)

GEOLOGY: On Pacific Ring of Fire, Subduction Zone





WORLD HAPPINESS REPORT 2026



✓ **Publishing Body:** UN Sustainable Development Solutions Network (SDSN)

✓ **Theme:** Social Media and Wellbeing

✓ **India's Rank:** 116th (Out of 147, Marginal improvement from 118th in 2025)

✓ **Top 3 Performers:** 1. Finland (9th consecutive year)
2. Iceland 3. Denmark

✓ **Key Takeaways:**

- No major English-speaking country in Top 10
- Low Social Support and Corruption perception are challenges for India
- Costa Rica climbed to 4th (highest for Latin America)



WORLD INVESTMENT REPORT 2025



✓ **Publishing Body:** UN Trade and Development (UNCTAD)

✓ **Key Focus:** FDI Trends, Global Slump, Digital Economy

✓ **India's Rank:** 15th (Improved from 16th)

✓ **Top Performers (FDI Inflows):** 1. USA 2. Brazil 3. Canada

✓ **Key Takeaways:** Global FDI declined 11%

- India ranked 4th globally in new Greenfield Projects (1,080 projects), indicating manufacturing confidence
- Major India FDI sources: Singapore, Mauritius



GLOBAL INNOVATION INDEX (GII) 2025



✓ **Publishing Body:** World Intellectual Property Organization (WIPO)

✓ **Theme:** Innovation at a Crossroads – Charting the Future

✓ **India's Rank:** 38th (Maintained status as 'innovation overperformer' for 15 straight years)

✓ **Top 3 Performers:** 1. Switzerland 2. Sweden 3. USA

✓ **Key Takeaways:**

- China entered Top 10 for the first time
- India #1 in Central/Southern Asia
- Leading in 'ICT services exports'



FUTURE OF JOBS REPORT 2025



✓ **Publishing Body:** World Economic Forum (WEF)

✓ **Timeframe:** Outlook to 2030

✓ **Key Trends:**

- Net job creation: 170M new vs. 92M displaced (78M net gain)
- ✓ **Fastest Growing Roles:** AI Specialists, Renewable Energy Engineers, Sustainability Specialists
- ✓ **India Insights:** 51% AI talent gap
- Paradox: Low overall unemployment but high educated youth unemployment (urban young women ~20%)
- EVs and Renewables are job engines

